

Complete Theme

Vocabulary — 24 words

Word	IPA	Turkish	Example
championship <i>noun</i>	/ˈtʃæm.pi.ən.ʃɪp/	şampiyona	Our school team won the regional championship last month.
opponent <i>noun</i>	/əˈpou.nənt/	rakip	The captain shook hands with her opponent before the match.
referee <i>noun</i>	/ˌref.əˈri:/	hakem	The referee gave a yellow card after the foul.
coach <i>noun</i>	/kəʊtʃ/	antrenör	The coach told the players to warm up before training.
training session <i>noun</i> <i>phrase</i>	/ˈtreɪ.nɪŋ ˌseʃ.ən/	antrenman seansı	The team had an extra training session before the final.
score <i>verb/noun</i>	/skoːr/	gol/puan atmak; skor	She scored the winning goal in the last minute.
defeat <i>verb/noun</i>	/dɪˈfi:t/	yenmek; yenilgi	The team suffered a narrow defeat in the semi-final.
victory <i>noun</i>	/ˈvɪk.tər.i/	zafer	Their victory in the final surprised everyone.
athlete <i>noun</i>	/ˈæθ.li:t/	sporcu	The young athlete broke the national record.
injury <i>noun</i>	/ˈɪn.dʒər.i/	sakatlık	He is out of the tournament because of a knee injury.
sportsmanship <i>noun</i>	/ˈspɔːrts.mən.ʃɪp/	sportmenlik	The players showed great sportsmanship after the match.
press conference <i>noun</i> <i>phrase</i>	/ˈpres ˌkɔːn.fər.əns/	basın toplantısı	The coach answered questions at the press conference.
headline <i>noun</i>	/ˈhed.laɪn/	başlık (haber)	The unexpected result made the front-page headline.
report <i>verb/noun</i>	/rɪˈpɔːrt/	haber vermek; rapor	Reporters reported the final score within minutes.
interview <i>noun/verb</i>	/ˈɪn.tər.vjuː/	röportaj; röportaj yapmak	The journalist interviewed the captain after the game.
commentator <i>noun</i>	/ˈkɔː.mən.teɪ.tər/	spor yorumcusu	The commentator praised the striker's performance.

Word	IPA	Turkish	Example
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supporter <i>noun</i>	/sə'pɔːr.tər/	tarafdar	Thousands of supporters travelled to watch the final.
tournament <i>noun</i>	/'tʊr.nə.mənt/	turnuva	The tournament lasted three weeks and had sixteen teams.
stadium <i>noun</i>	/'steɪ.di.əm/	stadyum	The stadium was full for the opening ceremony.
announce <i>verb</i>	/ə'naʊns/	duyurmak, açıklamak	The federation announced the new training schedule.
claim <i>verb</i>	/kleɪm/	iddia etmek	The coach claimed his team deserved to win.
admit <i>verb</i>	/əd'mɪt/	kabul etmek, itiraf etmek	The captain admitted that the team had played poorly.
explain <i>verb</i>	/ɪk'spleɪn/	açıklamak	The coach explained why he changed the tactics.
deny <i>verb</i>	/dɪ'naɪ/	reddetmek, inkâr etmek	The player denied breaking the rules of the game.

Reported Speech — Statements & Tense Back-shift

When we report a statement, the reporting verb (said, told) is usually in the past, so the tense of the original statement moves one step back into the past: present simple → past simple, present continuous → past continuous, past simple → past perfect, will → would, can → could.

Bir ifadeyi aktarırken, aktaran fiil (said, told) genellikle geçmiş zamanda olduğu için, orijinal cümlelerin zamanı bir adım geriye kayar: geniş zaman → geçmiş zaman, şimdiki zaman → geçmiş zamanın hikayesi, geçmiş zaman → miş'li geçmiş (had + V3), will → would, can → could.

When? We use reported speech to tell someone what another person said, without quoting their exact words — very common in sports news reports and interview summaries.

Reported speech, başka birinin söylediklerini onun tam kelimelerini alıntılardan aktarmak için kullanılır — spor haberlerinde ve röportaj özetlerinde çok sık görülür.

Positive

- Subject + said/told (object) + (that) + clause with back-shifted tense

Negative

- Subject + said + (that) + subject + did not/had not + verb

Question

- Not used for statements — see reporting questions in a later theme.

Short answers

- He said he was tired.
- She told me she had trained hard.

Common mistakes

- ~~He said he is tired.~~ → **He said he was tired.**
- ~~She told that she won the race.~~ → **She said that she had won the race.**

1. "I am ready for the match," she said. → She said she _____ ready for the match.

2. "We trained all summer," the team said. → The team said they _____ all summer.

3. "I will score a goal," the striker said. Reported speech:

- a. The striker said he will score a goal.
- b. The striker said he would score a goal.
- c. The striker said he scored a goal.
- d. The striker says he would score a goal.

4. "I can't play today," he said. → He said he can't play today. — *True / False*

5. "The referee made a mistake," the coach said. (*The coach said...*)

6. Put the words in order: he / said / tired / was / the coach

7. "I am watching the match," she said. → She said she _____ the match.

8. "We have won three championships," the captain said proudly. (*The captain said...*)

9. "I could not train yesterday because of my injury," the athlete said. Reported speech:

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- a. The athlete said she could not train the day before because of her injury.
- b. The athlete said she cannot train yesterday because of her injury.
- c. The athlete said she could not train yesterday because of her injury.
- d. The athlete says she could not train the day before because of her injury.

Reported Speech — Pronouns, Time Expressions & Reporting Verbs

In reported speech, pronouns change to match the reporter's point of view (I → he/she, my → his/her, we → they), and time/place expressions shift away from the moment of speaking (today → that day, tomorrow → the next day, yesterday → the day before, here → there). We also choose the reporting verb carefully: 'say' does not take a personal object (say something), while 'tell' needs one (tell someone something).

Reported speech'te zamirler, aktaran kişinin bakış açısına göre değişir (I → he/she, my → his/her, we → they); zaman/yer ifadeleri de konuşma anından uzaklaşacak şekilde değişir (today → that day, tomorrow → the next day, yesterday → the day before, here → there). Ayrıca aktaran fiil dikkatle seçilir: 'say' kişisel bir nesne almaz (say something), 'tell' ise bir nesneye ihtiyaç duyar (tell someone something).

When? We use these changes whenever the reporting happens at a different time or place from the original statement — for example, a journalist reporting a coach's comments a day after they were made.

Bu değişiklikler, aktarma işlemi orijinal ifadenin söylendiği zamandan veya yerden farklı bir zaman/yerde yapıldığında kullanılır — örneğin bir gazetecinin, bir antrenörün yorumlarını ertesi gün aktarması gibi.

Positive

- Subject + said/told (object) + (that) + clause with adjusted pronouns & time/place words

Negative

- Subject + said/told + (that) + subject + did not/had not + verb (adjusted pronouns & time/place words)

Question

- Not covered in this point — see statement patterns above.

Short answers

- He told me he was training then.
- They said they had played there.

Common mistakes

- ~~She said me she was tired.~~ → **She told me she was tired.**
- ~~He said he will play here tomorrow.~~ → **He said he would play there the next day.**

1. "I feel great," the athlete said. → The athlete said _____ felt great.

2. "We will train tomorrow," the coach said. → The coach said they would train _____.

3. "My team played well here," the captain said. Reported speech:

- a. The captain said his team had played well here.
- b. The captain said his team had played well there.
- c. The captain said my team had played well there.
- d. The captain said his team plays well there.

4. "I saw the match yesterday," she told me. → She told me she had seen the match yesterday. — *True / False*

5. "I will meet you here tomorrow," the reporter said. (*The reporter said...*)

6. Put the words in order: the coach / his / team / said / had trained / hard

7. "We won this championship last year, and we will win it again next year," the captain told the fans. (*The captain told the fans...*)

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8. Which sentence correctly reports: "I am not playing well this season," the striker admitted.

- a. The striker admitted he is not playing well this season.
- b. The striker admitted he was not playing well that season.
- c. The striker admitted he was not play well that season.
- d. The striker admits he was not playing well this season.

A Historic Win for the City Team

Before you read

- Look at the title. What do you think happened in the match?
- Have you ever watched a match that ended in a surprising result?

Last Saturday, the City Basketball Team achieved a historic victory in the regional championship final, defeating their long-time rivals by a score of 78 to 74. The match, held at the packed City Sports Hall, kept thousands of supporters on the edge of their seats until the final minute.

After the game, the team captain spoke to reporters. She said she had never felt so proud of her teammates. She explained that the players had trained twice a day for the past month and that their hard work had finally paid off. She also added that the whole team had believed in victory even when they were losing by ten points in the third quarter.

The coach told journalists that the turning point of the match had come when a young substitute player scored three important baskets in a row. He said the young player had shown great courage under pressure and that he was extremely proud of the entire squad. He also mentioned that the team would begin preparing immediately for the national tournament next month.

Fans who attended the match praised both teams for their sportsmanship. One supporter said the atmosphere in the hall had been unforgettable, with both sets of fans cheering loudly throughout the game. Local newspapers described the victory as one of the most exciting sporting moments the city had seen in years, and many are already looking forward to the national tournament.

1. What was the final score of the match?
 - a. 74 to 78
 - b. 78 to 74
 - c. 80 to 74
 - d. 78 to 70
2. The captain said she had never felt so proud of her teammates. — *True / False*
3. The coach said the turning point came when a young _____ player scored three baskets in a row.
4. According to the text, what will the team do next?
 - a. Retire from competition
 - b. Change their coach
 - c. Prepare for the national tournament
 - d. Play a friendly match
5. Rewrite in reported speech: "The atmosphere in the hall was unforgettable," the supporter said. (*The supporter said...*)
6. The team had been losing by ten points in the third quarter before the comeback. — *True / False*

After you read

- Why do you think the captain mentioned the team's training schedule?

- Do you think fair sportsmanship is as important as winning? Why or why not?

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Interview: Life of a Young Athlete

Before you read

- What questions would you ask a young professional athlete?
- What do you think is the hardest part of being a professional athlete?

Our school magazine recently interviewed Deniz Aksoy, a nineteen-year-old swimmer who recently qualified for the national team. In the interview, Deniz talked openly about training, sacrifice, and staying motivated.

When asked about her daily routine, Deniz explained that she woke up at five every morning to train before school. She said that balancing school work and swimming was the most difficult part of her life as a student athlete. She added that her family had always supported her, even when she felt like giving up.

The interviewer asked Deniz what advice she would give to young people who wanted to become athletes. She replied that discipline was more important than natural talent, and she said that anyone could improve with consistent practice. She also mentioned that she had failed to qualify for the national team twice before finally succeeding this year.

Deniz told the interviewer that her biggest goal was to represent her country at an international competition. She said she was not afraid of losing, because every competition taught her something new. Finally, she admitted that without the support of her coach and family, she would never have achieved her dream.

The interview ended with Deniz thanking her school for allowing her to combine her studies with intense training, and she encouraged other students to follow their passions, whatever they might be.

1. Deniz said she woke up at _____ every morning to train.
2. According to Deniz, what is more important than natural talent?
 - a. Money
 - b. Discipline
 - c. Luck
 - d. Equipment
3. Deniz qualified for the national team on her first attempt. — *True / False*
4. Rewrite in reported speech: "My family has always supported me," Deniz said. (*Deniz said...*)
5. What is Deniz's biggest goal, according to the interview?
 - a. To become a coach
 - b. To win a scholarship
 - c. To represent her country internationally
 - d. To change sports

After you read

- What personal quality do you think helped Deniz succeed the most?
- Would you be willing to make similar sacrifices for a goal you care about?

Radio Sports News: Local Derby Result

Before you listen

- What information do you expect to hear in a radio sports news report?
- Predict two facts you might hear about a football match result.

1. Riverside won the match by _____ goals to one.
2. The Riverside coach said the training on set pieces had paid off. — *True / False*
3. What did the losing coach admit?
 - a. That the referee was unfair
 - b. That his team had made too many mistakes in defence
 - c. That his best player was injured
 - d. That the stadium was too small
4. Rewrite in reported speech: "It is not serious," the club doctor said. (*The club doctor said...*)

Interview: A Coach Talks About the New Season

Before you listen

- What questions might a journalist ask a coach at the start of a new season?
 - What kind of goals do sports teams usually set at the beginning of a season?
1. What did the coach tell the players about the new season?
 - a. It would be the same as last season
 - b. It would be different from last season
 - c. It would be his last season
 - d. It would be shorter than usual
 2. The coach admitted the team's defence had been too weak. — *True / False*
 3. The coach told the board that the goal was to finish in the top _____.
 4. Rewrite in reported speech: "Everyone will need to work harder," the coach explained. (*The coach explained...*)

Athlete Interview Role-Play

Pairs · 8-10 min

One student plays a journalist and the other plays an athlete or coach after an important match. The journalist asks at least five questions; the athlete/coach answers in character. Afterwards, each pair reports three things their partner said to the class using reported speech.

Useful language: Can you tell us how you feel about...?, What was the turning point of the match?, I felt that..., Our coach told us that..., He/She said (that)..., He/She told me (that)...

1. In pairs, decide who is the journalist and who is the athlete/coach.
2. The journalist prepares 5 interview questions about a recent match or competition.
3. Role-play the interview, speaking naturally.
4. Swap roles and repeat with a new topic.
5. Each student reports 3 things their partner said to the class, using reported speech.

Sports Debate: Fair Play vs Winning at All Costs

Groups of 3-4 · 10-12 min

In small groups, students discuss whether winning is more important than playing fairly, using examples from sports they know. Each group presents a short summary of their discussion to the class, including at least one reported statement from a group member.

Useful language: In my opinion..., I think fair play is more important because..., Some people believe that..., One of my classmates said that..., I disagree because...

1. In groups, discuss: Is it acceptable to break the rules if it helps your team win?
2. Give real or imagined examples of fair play and unfair play in sports.
3. Agree on a short group opinion.
4. Choose one group member to summarise the discussion for the class, quoting a group member's opinion in reported speech.

Writing

Write a Sports News Report

120-150 words

Write a short sports news report about an imaginary match or competition. Include a headline, the result, at least two reported statements from a player or coach, and a closing sentence about what happens next.

Plan:

1. Choose a sport and decide the result of the match/competition.
2. Write a short, catchy headline.
3. Note down 2-3 quotes a player or coach might have said.
4. Turn those quotes into reported speech for your report.
5. Add a final sentence about future plans (next match, tournament, etc.).

Checklist:

- ☐ Does my report have a clear headline?
- ☐ Have I included the score/result?
- ☐ Have I used at least two correctly formed reported statements?
- ☐ Have I checked tense back-shift and pronoun changes?

Interview Script and Summary

150-180 words

Write a short interview script (5 questions and answers) with an imaginary athlete or coach about a recent competition. Then write a short paragraph (4-6 sentences) summarising the interview using reported speech.

Plan:

1. Choose your interviewee (athlete, coach) and the topic (a recent win, a big goal, an injury, etc.).
2. Write 5 interview questions.
3. Write natural, original answers for the interviewee.
4. Rewrite the key answers as reported speech in a short summary paragraph.
5. Check that reporting verbs (said, told, explained, admitted) are used correctly.

Checklist:

- ☐ Does my script have 5 clear questions and answers?
- ☐ Does my summary paragraph use reported speech correctly?
- ☐ Have I used at least two different reporting verbs?
- ☐ Is my paragraph well organised with linking words?

1. "I am training every day," the athlete said. Reported speech:
 - a. The athlete said he trains every day.
 - b. The athlete said he was training every day.
 - c. The athlete said he is training every day.
 - d. The athlete says he was training every day.
2. Complete: a person who watches and supports a team is called a _____.
3. A referee's job is to write sports news articles. — *True / False*
4. Rewrite in reported speech: "We will win the next match," the captain said. (*The captain said...*)
5. Which sentence uses 'tell' correctly?
 - a. She told that she was tired.
 - b. She told me that she was tired.
 - c. She said me that she was tired.
 - d. She told about she was tired.
6. Put the words in order: had won / said / the coach / the match / they
7. "I saw the game yesterday," he said. → He said he had seen the game _____.
8. Which word means 'a place where large sports events are held'?
 - a. referee
 - b. stadium
 - c. tournament
 - d. commentator
9. In reported speech, 'here' usually changes to 'there'. — *True / False*
10. Rewrite in reported speech: "My team is playing well this season," the fan said. (*The fan said...*)

Support

1. Match 8 sports vocabulary words from this theme to their Turkish meanings.
2. Fill in 5 gap-fill sentences changing direct speech to reported speech, using a given word bank.
3. Copy and complete 4 sentences: "I am tired," she said. → She said she ____ tired.
4. Listen again to Listening 1 and write down 3 facts you hear.

Core

1. Rewrite 6 direct sentences from a short sports dialogue into reported speech.
2. Write a 100-word sports news report about an imaginary match, including 2 reported statements.
3. Write 5 original interview questions for an athlete and short model answers.
4. Complete 6 mixed practice items (gap-fill, MCQ, rewrite) on Reported Speech.

Extension

1. Write a 150-word interview summary using at least 4 different reporting verbs (said, told, explained, admitted).
2. Find or imagine 3 real quotes from athletes and rewrite them all in reported speech, noting any tricky changes.
3. Write a short dialogue between a journalist and two athletes with contrasting opinions, then summarise it in reported speech.
4. Research (in your own words, not copied) one famous sports event and write a short reported-speech news paragraph about it.

Vocabulary

1. The player broke a rule, so the _____ showed him a yellow card.
2. A journalist's job includes...
 - a. training athletes
 - b. reporting sports news
 - c. playing matches
 - d. coaching a team
3. The team celebrated their _____ after winning the final.

Grammar — Reported Speech

1. "I feel proud of my team," the coach said. (*The coach said...*)
2. "We trained here yesterday," the players said. Reported speech:
 - a. The players said they trained here yesterday.
 - b. The players said they had trained there the day before.
 - c. The players said they train there yesterday.
 - d. The players say they had trained here the day before.
3. "I will help the team," she said. → She said she _____ help the team.

Reading

1. In 'A Historic Win for the City Team', who scored three baskets in a row?
 - a. The captain
 - b. A young substitute player
 - c. The coach
 - d. A supporter
2. In 'Interview: Life of a Young Athlete', Deniz qualified for the national team on her first try. — *True / False*

Listening

1. In the radio report, Riverside won by _____ goals to one.
2. In the coach interview, what was the team's main goal for the season?
 - a. Win every match
 - b. Finish in the top three
 - c. Sign new players
 - d. Avoid injuries

Writing

1. Write one sentence reporting a coach's statement about the team's performance, using 'said that'. (*The coach said...*)